

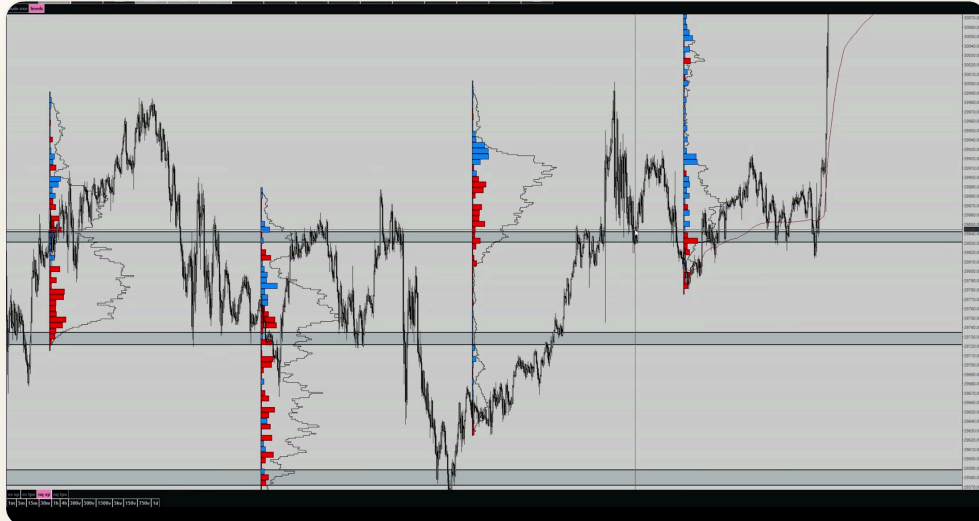
ETHOS ORDER FLOW / EDUCATION



Who's In Control

Reading a high timeframe balance, and why the lower timeframe has to confirm it before you trade

SAINT ✕ ETHOS ORDER FLOW



AMT • HTF / LTF ALIGNMENT • LIVE EXAMPLES • 12 PAGES

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The basics: a balance needs confirmation at its extremes

why AMT alone never tells you whether it rejects or accepts

AMT gives you the shape of the range, not the outcome. If price trends up into an extreme, the framework says it should come back down. If sellers aren't actually present at that extreme, the more likely outcome is a break and continuation, sometimes with a retest of that same extreme first, sometimes not, sometimes just a straight continuation with no retest at all.

The same logic runs in both directions. At a high, if sellers are stronger than the buyers pushing into it, price most likely comes back down. If buyers are the stronger side, price is more likely to break out, retest, and continue higher. Either way, the extreme by itself decides nothing. What happens there is what decides it, and there is no way to know that in advance, only ways to read it as it happens.

"There really is no way of knowing. Some of the ways I like to understand it is the aggression."

Reading the aggression into the extreme

an aggressive push signals intent, a slow drift signals none

The first read: how does price actually arrive at the extreme. An aggressive move, buyers pushing in hard and fast, signals that side wants higher prices and is likely to defend the balance once it gets there. A slow, grinding move into the same extreme signals the opposite: no real interest in holding prices up there, which hands the opposition an opening to step in, take control, and push price back through the whole range.

This is the first filter, before any level or retest gets involved. The same extreme, reached two different ways, is two different situations. Reached aggressively, it's a level to expect defended. Reached slowly, it's a level to expect broken.

Using a previous balance to know who's in control

the breakout, then the retest, is what actually confirms it

The second read applies when you've missed the moment a decision was made, when you don't know whether sellers were absorbed at a high or genuinely took control. The fix is to use a previous balance and watch what price does around it.

If price trends, fails to break the previous balance's low, and comes back up, that's telling you buyers are most likely in control. No short is valid yet. A short only becomes valid once price breaks that low, comes back up for a genuine retest, and then continues lower from there, that sequence is what confirms sellers are still in control, not the break by itself.

And if sellers aren't strong enough to push through on that retest, the read flips again: buyers are likely to absorb them, or sellers simply have no real interest in pushing lower, and buyers take the opportunity to drive price back up instead.

This exact read, live, is what gets walked through every session inside the mentorship.

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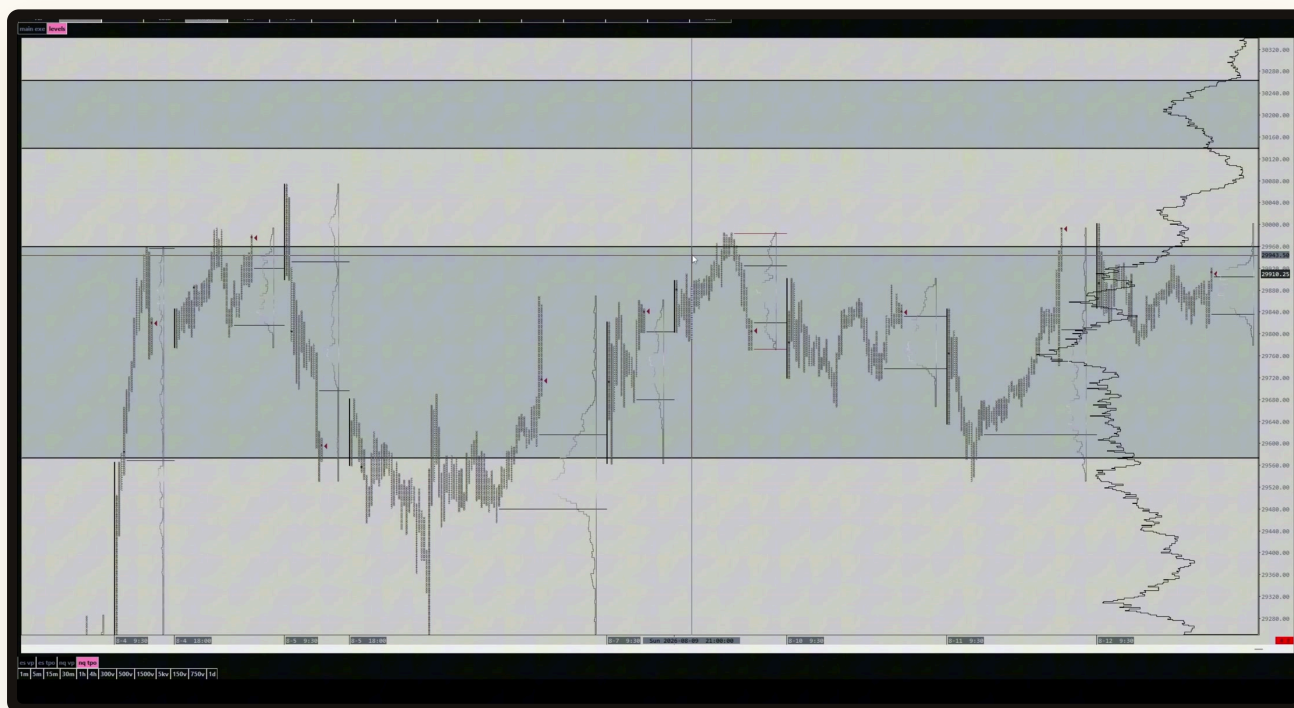
Trapped buyers on the higher timeframe

an aggressive push that fades, and why that fuels the move down

On the higher timeframe auction shown, price pushed up and failed to hold. The Delta told the story before price fully confirmed it: buyers were a lot stronger going in, then visibly faded. That fade is the tell. Buyers came in aggressively, got exhausted, and lost interest in pushing any higher.

The consequence follows directly: those buyers are now trapped, and a trapped position eventually has to be sold to get out of. That forced selling doesn't fight the move down, it fuels it, which is exactly why sellers taking control from here tends to be a more amplified move than sellers taking control from a level with no trapped buyers behind it. This alone was enough to start looking for shorts.

THE HTF PUSH THAT FADED: BUYERS STRONG, THEN VISIBLY EXHAUSTED ON THE DELTA



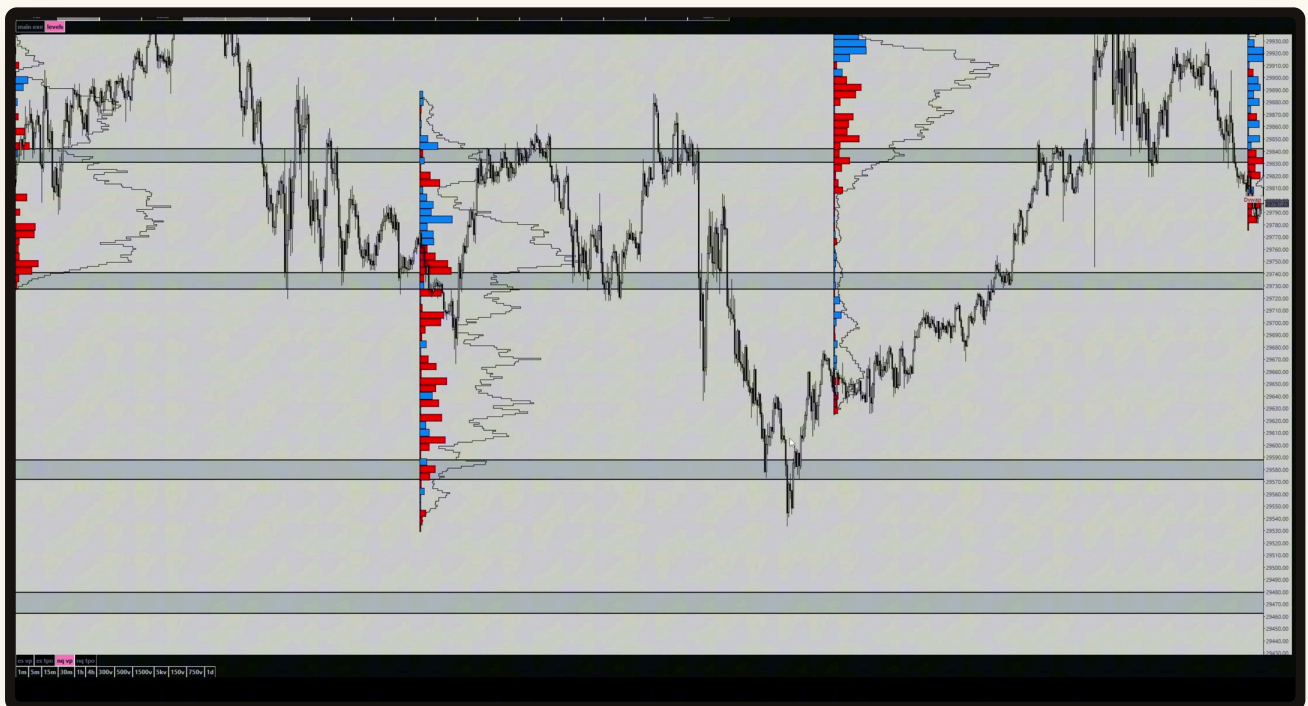
The chop at the old balance, and why no trade was right

waiting through a range that gave nothing to work with

Coming into the previous balance, the read went quiet on purpose. Neither side could push and hold: a retest would push back higher, but not maintain it, then the same pattern would repeat. That's not indecision to trade around, it's the market explicitly not giving you anything yet.

The discipline shown here matters as much as the read itself: no trades were taken through this entire stretch, not because nothing was happening, but because nothing had been confirmed. The wait ended only once sellers aggressively broke through the level and got their retest, at which point the earlier trapped-buyers read and this fresh confirmation lined up together.

THE OLD BALANCE, MARKED, WHERE NEITHER SIDE COULD HOLD A PUSH



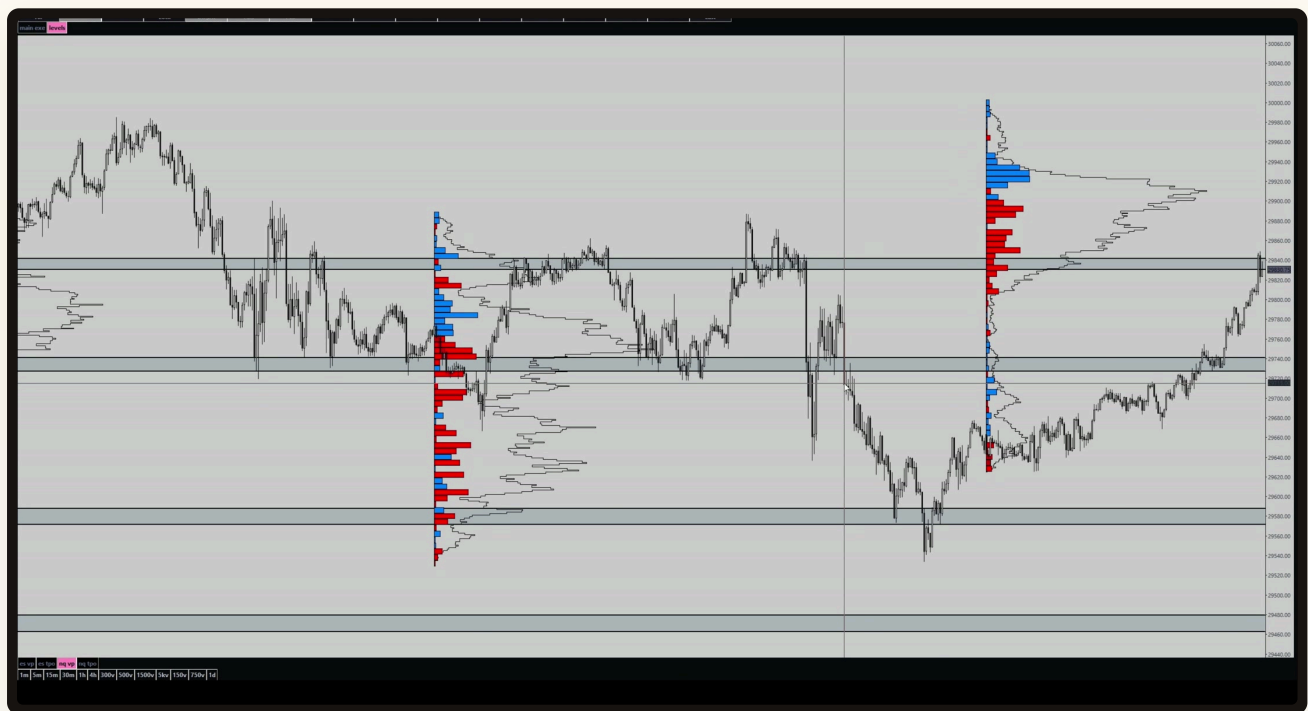
The retest that confirmed sellers

the exact pattern from the basics chapter, played out live

This is the breakout-then-retest sequence from earlier, on the actual chart. Sellers broke the level aggressively, price came back up for the retest, and instead of buyers reclaiming control the way they had on prior attempts, sellers gained more momentum than buyers and pushed price lower from there. That's the confirmation. Not the initial break, the retest that held.

The trade was live: this setup was taken in real time, and the read was checked against the actual session recap afterward rather than assumed after the fact.

THE BREAKOUT, THE RETEST, AND SELLERS TAKING MORE MOMENTUM THAN BUYERS



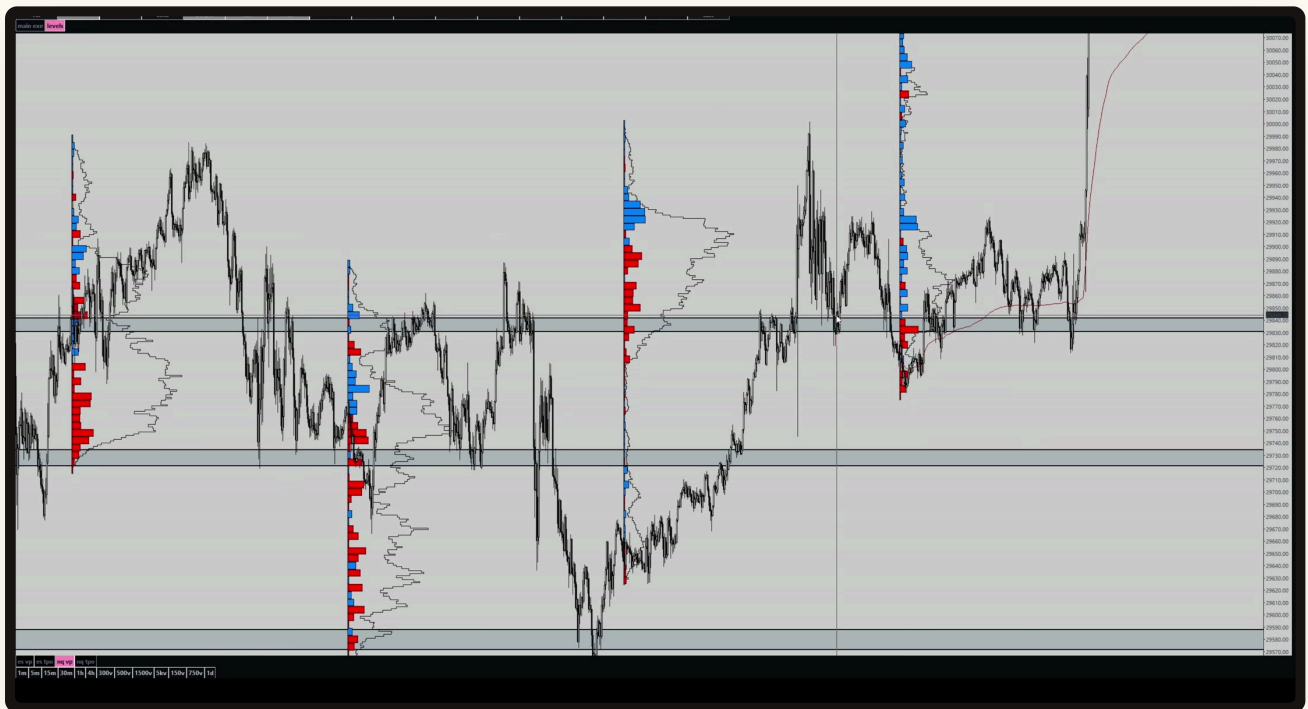
Dropping to the 15 minute for the final confirmation

aggressive selling with no reaction lower, then the reversal

Approaching the upper extreme later in the session, the higher timeframe gave nothing obvious again, no clear buying, no clear selling. Rather than force a read off the higher timeframe alone, the check moved down to the 15 minute.

There, price was unable to break lower, buyers were visibly defending the area, and on the Delta there was aggressive selling with no reaction lower to show for it, sellers pushing and simply not getting paid. A retest was planned to see if sellers could still assert control. They couldn't, and buyers rampaged higher from there. The higher timeframe extreme meant nothing on its own until the lower timeframe supplied the confirmation.

AGGRESSIVE SELLING, NO REACTION LOWER, THEN BUYERS TAKING OVER



Why alignment is the whole method

the higher timeframe read is a bias, not a trade, until price agrees

Across the whole session, the strongest trade wasn't the first place price looked tradeable, it was the retest that came after sellers had already proven they could take control once. Everywhere else in the range, control was, in his own words, "free game," up for grabs to whichever side showed up. Down at the level that had already been broken and retested, sellers had already demonstrated the read, and the second retest simply repeated it.

His own summary closes the method: even when the higher timeframe gives you a reaction, you need to confirm it, back it up by checking whether the lower timeframe is actually showing you that price wants to go the direction the higher timeframe suggested. A bias without that confirmation is a guess wearing a framework. It's all about alignment.

The checklist

every rule in this document, printable

READING THE EXTREME

- ☐ I've checked whether price arrived aggressively (defend it) or slowly (expect it broken).
- ☐ I'm not assuming rejection or acceptance from the extreme alone.

USING A PREVIOUS BALANCE

- ☐ I have a breakout AND a retest that held, not just the breakout.
- ☐ If the retest failed to hold, I've flipped my read to the other side rather than forcing the original one.

TRAPPED POSITIONING

- ☐ I can point to an aggressive push on Delta that visibly faded, not just assume exhaustion.
- ☐ I understand that trapped positioning fuels the move against it, not just fails to stop it.

WHEN THE HIGHER TIMEFRAME GIVES NOTHING

- ☐ I'm willing to take no trade through a genuine chop, rather than force one.
- ☐ I've dropped to a lower timeframe (his default: 15 minute) for confirmation before acting on a higher timeframe bias.

One balance.

Two timeframes agreeing before it's a trade.

Nothing in this document is a promise about what a trial gets you specifically. It's one teacher's real method for a question that doesn't have a clean textbook answer: whether a balance has actually been accepted or rejected, read the only way it can be, by watching what price actually does at the extreme and confirming it on a lower timeframe before acting on it.

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Live sessions, daily, where this read gets walked through on the actual chart.

Companion reading: Trapped Buyers, One Retest, free at kanji.org.uk.

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